How the World Is Governed

A feature-by-feature classification of 197 systems of government, cross-checked against V-Dem and the CIA World Factbook

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DOI: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23863540

2026

Abstract

Maps of political regimes usually sort countries into democracies and autocracies. I classify the constitutional form of all 197 states (the 193 UN members, the Holy See, Palestine, Taiwan and Kosovo) on eight features: the kind of head of state, how that office is filled, the executive type (including the premier-presidential and president-parliamentary subtypes of semi-presidentialism), whether head of state and head of government are one office, the territorial structure, the number of chambers, the electoral system of the lower or only chamber and any power sharing fixed by community. Each field is derived by stated rules from two independent sources, V-Dem v16 (latest year 2025) and the CIA World Factbook (2026 and 2024 editions), compared cell by cell, with 83 documented and cited hand decisions. The countries fall into 12 families and 112 exact systems, of which 80 belong to a single country; those 80 countries hold 42% of the world's population. The largest shared system, unitary parliamentary republics with one chamber elected by list proportional representation, has 14 members. Presidential republics (52) and parliamentary republics (45) are the largest families and each holds over a quarter of humanity; 25 federations hold 41%. Set against V-Dem's Regimes of the World, 71% of countries electing their lower house by proportional representation are democracies against 43% of majoritarian ones, 78% of premier-presidential against 11% of president-parliamentary systems, and ceremonial monarchies have the highest mean Liberal Democracy Index of any family (0.64). These patterns are descriptive. The classification, sources and decisions are released as open data.

Keywords: political systems; forms of government; semi-presidentialism; federalism; electoral systems; V-Dem; Regimes of the World; CIA World Factbook; comparative politics; open data

1 Introduction

The most widely used maps of political systems answer one question: is a country democratic? V-Dem's Regimes of the World (Lührmann et al., 2018), Freedom House and the Economist Intelligence Unit each give two to four classes. They are indispensable, but they describe the quality of a regime rather than its architecture. Two parliamentary republics with ceremonial presidents, Germany and Italy, sit in the same class on such a map, yet Germany is a federation whose Bundestag is elected by mixed-member proportional representation, while Italy is a regionalised state whose Chamber of Deputies is elected by a parallel system. Political scientists have long distinguished these features (Lijphart, 2012; Shugart and Carey, 1992; Elgie, 2011; Reynolds et al., 2005); open, current, global datasets that put them together for every country are rarer.

This paper builds one. It classifies all 197 states on eight features of constitutional form and practice, derives each field by stated rules from two independent sources, records where they disagree, and documents every hand decision with a citation. It then groups identical combinations ("signatures") into a hierarchy of families and exact systems, counts how widely each is shared and

how many people live under it, and sets the classification beside V-Dem's democracy measures. An interactive version is at https://maps.tristanhotham.com/government-types/.

2 Data

V-Dem. The V-Dem Country-Year Dataset v16 (Coppedge et al., 2026), as packaged in the vdemdata R package 16.0 (Maerz et al., 2026), latest year 2025, licensed CC BY-SA 4.0 (as listed in the Swedish National Data Service catalogue, https://researchdata.se/en/catalogue/dataset/ext0309-1). I use the Regimes of the World classification (v2x_regime), the Liberal and Electoral Democracy Indices (v2x_libdem, v2x_polyarchy) with their intervals, and institutional indicators: how the head of state reached office (v2expathhs), whether head of state and head of government are the same (v2exhoshog), the head of state's relative power over the cabinet (v2ex_hosw), whether the head of state could remove the head of government in practice (v2exrmhgnp_5), the hereditary, military and party dimensions of the executive's power base, the number of chambers (v2lgbicam), the share of the lower chamber directly elected (v2lgello) and the thirteen-category electoral system of the latest election to the lower chamber (v2elloelsy). V-Dem covers 175 of the 197 states; the 22 not covered are microstates and small island states.

CIA World Factbook. The Factbook as JSON (CIA, 2026), at the repository's final 2026 state and at commit 379131b4 (December 2024), the last snapshot with full-text descriptions of each legislature. The Factbook is a US government work in the public domain. I use its government type, executive branch (chief of state, head of government, election process), legislative structure and electoral system, administrative divisions, and international organisation membership (to define the set of UN member states).

Population and boundaries. World Bank total population for 2025 (World Bank, 2026), with Natural Earth estimates for Taiwan and the Holy See; Natural Earth 1:50m and 1:10m countries (Natural Earth, 2026).

Wikidata and Wikipedia's lists of countries by system of government and by electoral system would make a natural third source; they could not be retrieved for this version and are not used.

3 Methods

3.1 Fields and rules

Head of state. A country is a monarchy if V-Dem codes its head of state as having reached office by hereditary succession, a royal council or appointment by a foreign power (the Commonwealth realms), or, for countries outside V-Dem, if the Factbook calls it one. A monarchy is *absolute* if the Factbook says so; *constitutional with a ruling monarch* (dualist) if V-Dem codes the head of state as at least as powerful as the head of government over the cabinet (v2ex_hosw ≥ 0.5) or the hereditary dimension as at least 0.5; otherwise *ceremonial*. The office is recorded as hereditary, elective, a monarch abroad or co-princes for monarchies, and as a president, a collective presidency or a Supreme Leader for republics.

Executive. Military government (a head of state who took power by force or was appointed by the military, with a military power base of at least 0.5), one-party state (Factbook "communist" or a head of state appointed by the ruling party) and the theocratic and transitional cases (Factbook labels, hand decisions) are assigned first. Monarchies take the executive implied by the monarch's power. For republics, a directly elected president who is also head of government is

presidential; a head of state who is also head of government but chosen by or through the legislature gives a *parliamentary system with an executive president*, Switzerland's collegial Federal Council a *directorial* system; a head of state not directly elected, with a separate head of government, is *parliamentary*. A directly elected president with a separate prime minister is *semi-presidential* if the Factbook calls the system presidential or semi-presidential or V-Dem codes the president as at least as powerful as the prime minister; otherwise parliamentary. Following Shugart and Carey (1992), semi-presidential systems are *president-parliamentary* where the president can also remove the prime minister (V-Dem v2exrmhgnp_5 above 0.5) and *premier-presidential* otherwise; France and Ukraine are set by their constitutions, which give the president no such power, although V-Dem's in-practice coding differs.

Territory, chambers, elections and power sharing. Federations are those the Factbook calls federal, plus Argentina and Bosnia and Herzegovina; Italy, Spain and the United Kingdom are *regionalised*; *unitary with autonomous regions* comes from autonomous units in the Factbook's administrative divisions with hand additions and exclusions. Chambers are V-Dem's count of sitting chambers ("none sitting" where a legislature is dissolved or suspended), checked against the Factbook. The electoral system is V-Dem's code for the latest election, checked against the Factbook's 2026 category and a parse of its 2024 text; a chamber less than half directly elected is "indirect or appointed". Power sharing is coded only where the constitution or a binding pact allocates top offices or seats by community (Lebanon, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Belgium, Burundi).

Precedence and cross-checks. For each field a hand decision overrides the rule, V-Dem's in-practice coding is preferred to the Factbook where both exist, and the Factbook is used alone where V-Dem is silent. Each country and field cell records its source values and whether the sources agree, disagree, or only one speaks.

3.2 Families and signatures

A country's *signature* is the combination of its eight fields. Identical signatures form an *exact system*. *Families* group countries by head of state and executive into 12 classes; *sub-families* split each family by the broad class of electoral system (majoritarian, mixed or semi-proportional, proportional, not directly elected), giving 39 sub-families. All statistics are descriptive counts and population shares, with population weights from 2025.

4 Results

4.1 Families

Table 1 and Figures 1 and 2 summarise the families. Presidential republics (52 countries, 27% of the world's population) and parliamentary republics (45, 28%) are the largest, followed by 29 parliamentary monarchies (6%), 14 of them Commonwealth realms. Semi-presidential systems number 27: 18 president-parliamentary, holding 8% of the world's people, and 9 premier-presidential (2%). One-party states are only 6 but hold 19% of humanity. In all, 30 countries with 28% of the world's people are governed by a party, the military, clerics, a royal family or a transitional authority. There are 43 monarchies (8% of the population) and 25 federations (41%).

Table 1: The twelve families: countries, share of world population, exact systems, one-country systems and mean V-Dem Liberal Democracy Index (countries covered by V-Dem).

Family	Countries	Population	Systems	Unique	Mean LDI
Parliamentary monarchies	29	6.3%	20	16	0.64
Ruling monarchies	7	0.7%	7	7	0.18
Absolute monarchies	6	0.7%	5	4	0.09
Parliamentary republics	45	27.6%	22	17	0.50
Assembly-chosen executives	7	1.0%	6	5	0.59
Semi-presidential, premier-presidential	9	1.9%	6	3	0.50
Semi-presidential, president-parliamentary	18	7.8%	9	5	0.17
Presidential republics	52	27.2%	20	10	0.38
One-party states	6	19.0%	4	3	0.06
Military governments	8	2.9%	4	2	0.11
Theocracies	3	1.7%	3	3	0.06
Transitional or divided authority	7	3.4%	6	5	0.08

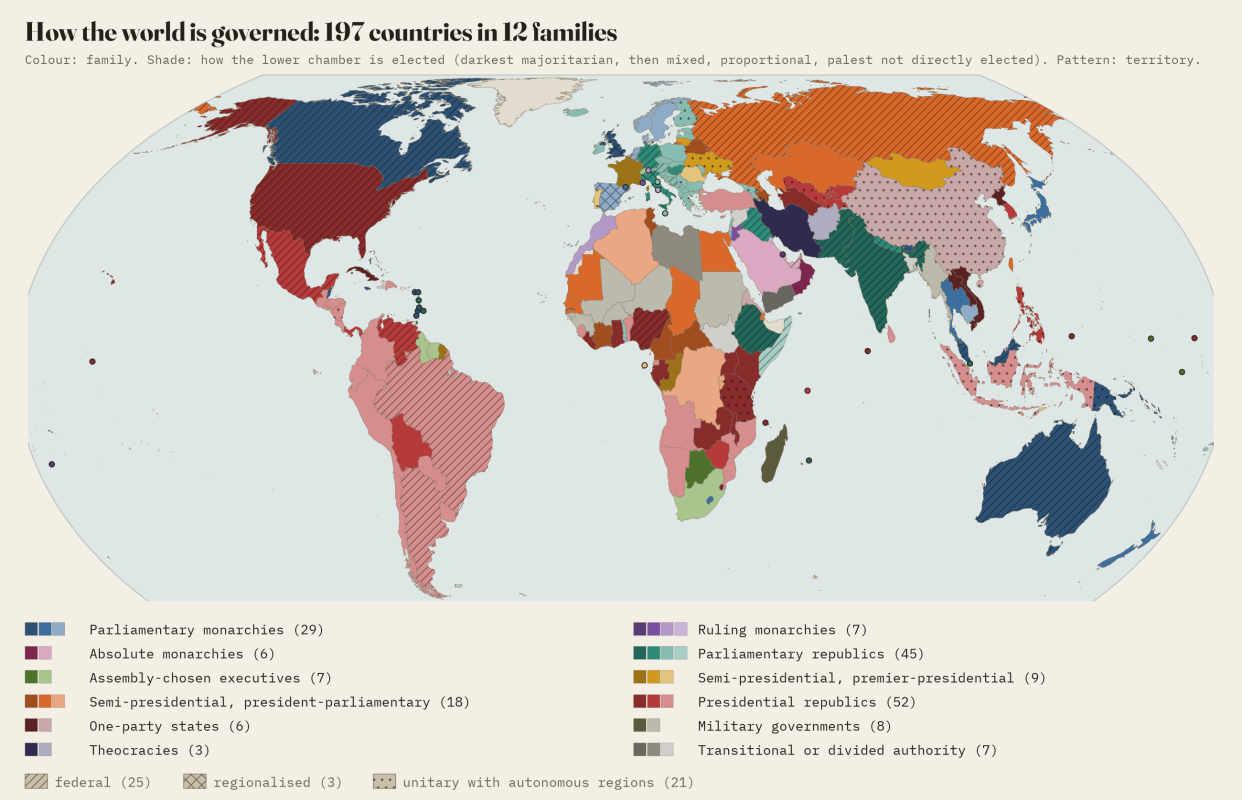


Figure 1: Families of government, shaded by the electoral system of the lower or only chamber, with patterns for federal, regionalised and autonomous-region states (Equal Earth projection).

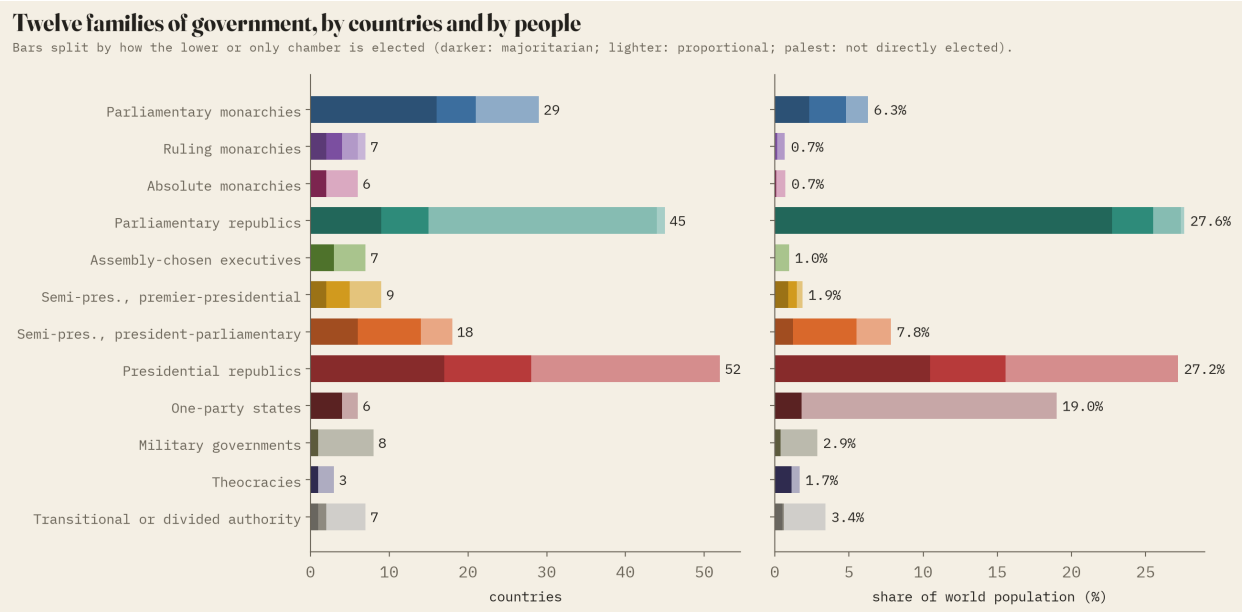


Figure 2: Countries and share of world population in each family, split by electoral system.

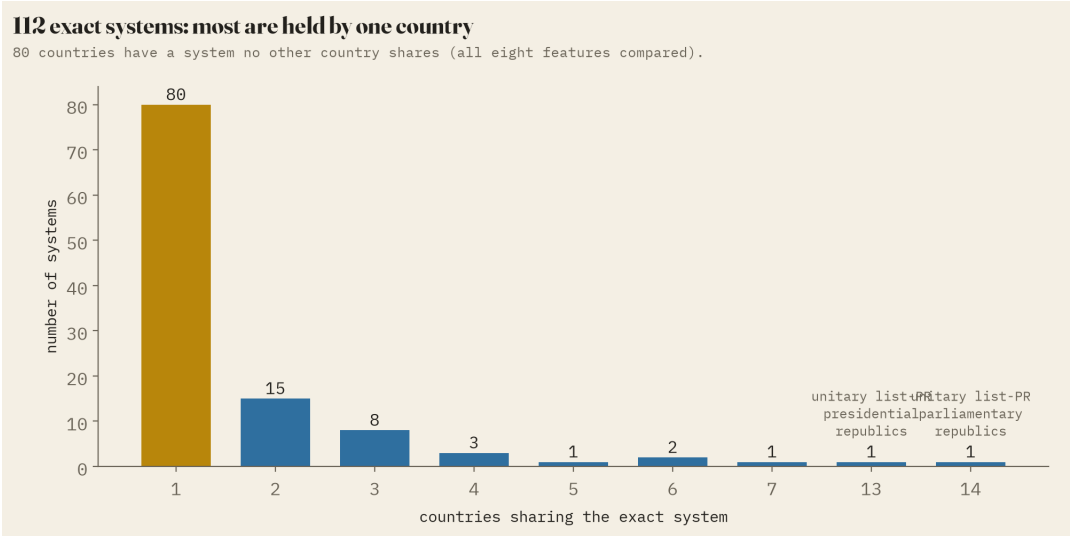


Figure 3: How many countries share each exact system.

4.2 Exact systems

The 197 countries have 112 distinct signatures. 32 are shared by two or more countries (117 countries in all) and 80 are unique (Figure 3, Table 2). The largest shared system has 14 members, mostly in central and eastern Europe; the second, its presidential counterpart, has 13. India, Pakistan and Ethiopia share an exact system, as do the United States and Nigeria and Brazil and Argentina. Germany and Italy differ in territory and electoral system. France and the Republic of the Congo share an exact system although V-Dem scores their liberal democracy at 0.80 and 0.12. The unique systems include the most populous states with idiosyncratic designs (China, Indonesia, Russia, Mexico, Japan, Iran, Germany) and the textbook one-offs: Switzerland's directorial Federal Council, Bosnia's three-member presidency, Lebanon's confessional parliament, Andorra's co-princes and the Holy See. Without the power-sharing field, Lebanon would share its signature with Israel.

Table 2: The ten most widely shared exact systems.

System	N	Features	Countries
S001	14	Republic; Parliamentary; Unitary; Unicameral; List PR	Albania, Armenia, Bulgaria, Cabo Verde, Croatia, Estonia, Fiji, Iceland, Israel, Kosovo, Latvia, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Slovakia
S002	13	Republic; Presidential; Unitary; Unicameral; List PR	Angola, Benin, Costa Rica, Cyprus, Ecuador, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Mozambique, Peru, Sierra Leone, Sri Lanka, Turkey
S003	7	Republic; Presidential; Unitary; Bicameral; List PR	Chile, Colombia, Dominican Republic, Equatorial Guinea, Namibia, Paraguay, Uruguay
S005	6	Republic; Presidential; Unitary; Unicameral; FPTP	Gambia, Ghana, Malawi, Maldives, Uganda, Zambia
S004	6	Ceremonial monarchy; Parliamentary; Unitary; Bicameral; FPTP	Antigua and Barbuda, Bahamas, Belize, Grenada, Jamaica, Saint Lucia
S006	5	Republic; Parliamentary; Unitary, auton. regions; Unicameral; List PR	Finland, Georgia, Greece, Moldova, Serbia
S007	4	Republic; Military government; Unitary; Unicameral; Indirect/appointed	Burkina Faso, Guinea, Mali, Niger
S009	4	Republic; Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.); Unitary; Bicameral; Two-round	Belarus, Cameroon, Côte d'Ivoire, Tunisia
S008	4	Republic; Parliamentary; Unitary; Bicameral; List PR	Czechia, Poland, Slovenia, Togo
S012	3	Republic; Parliamentary; Federal; Bicameral; FPTP	Ethiopia, India, Pakistan

4.3 Single features

List proportional representation is the commonest electoral system for the lower or only chamber (73 countries) but covers only 19% of the world's people; first past the post is used by 38 countries with 36%, 62% of them in India and the United States (Figure 4). Mixed systems are used by 34 countries (24 parallel, 10 mixed-member proportional). 22 countries, with 24% of the world's people, have no directly elected lower chamber or none sitting. 81 legislatures are bicameral, 107 unicameral, and 9 countries have no sitting legislature. In 64 countries one person or body is both head of state and head of government.

4.4 Form and freedom

V-Dem classes 33 countries as closed autocracies, 55 as electoral autocracies, 56 as electoral democracies and 31 as liberal democracies for 2025; 73% of the world's people live in autocracies and 8% in liberal democracies. Figure 5 crosses the electoral system with regime type: 71% of proportional, 44% of mixed and 43% of majoritarian countries are democracies, and 26%, 25% and 8% respectively are liberal democracies. Among the 31 liberal democracies, 61% use proportional representation, 26% a mixed system and 13% a majoritarian one.

Figure 6 shows the Liberal Democracy Index by family. The 20 ceremonial monarchies scored by V-Dem have the highest mean (0.64, against 0.50 for parliamentary republics); 10 of them are liberal democracies, and the three highest-scoring countries on V-Dem's index are Denmark, Sweden and Norway. Cambodia, Papua New Guinea and Thailand are ceremonial monarchies classed as autocracies. Where the monarch rules, scores are low: the mean is 0.18 for ruling and 0.09 for absolute monarchies. 78% of premier-presidential countries are democracies against 11% of

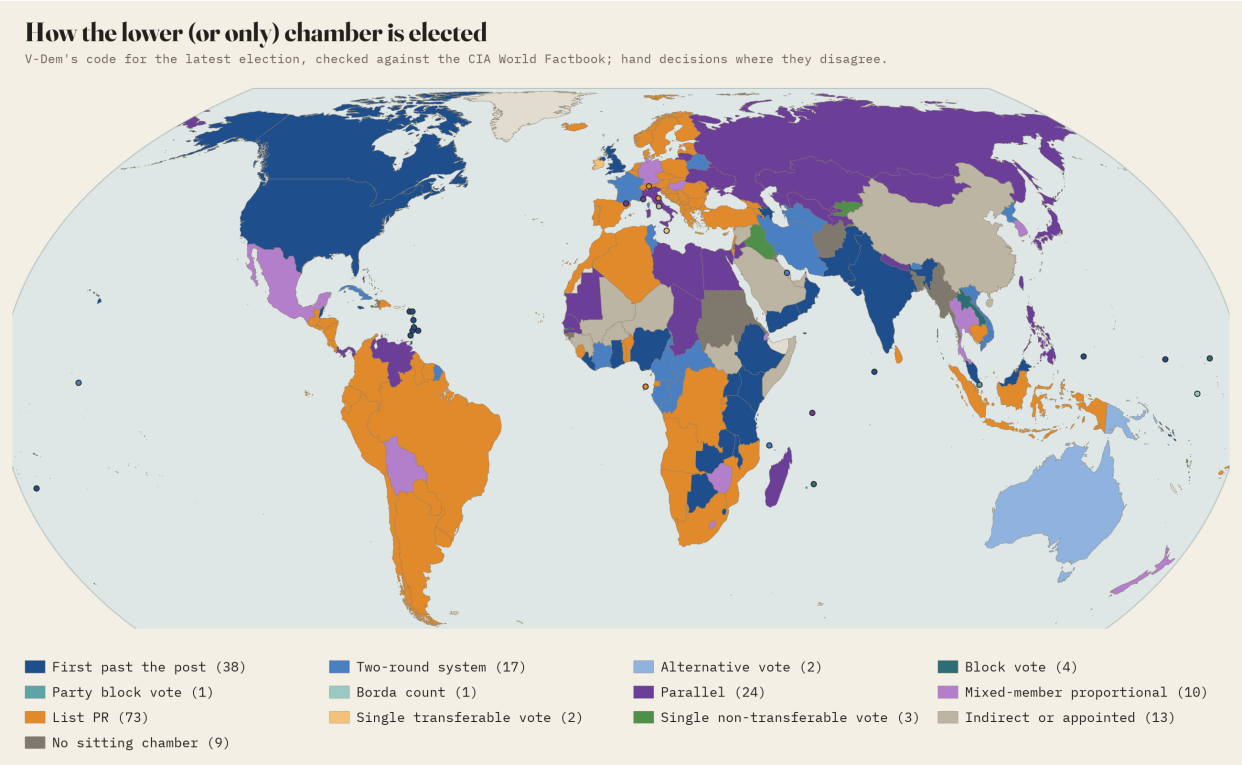


Figure 4: Electoral system of the lower or only chamber.

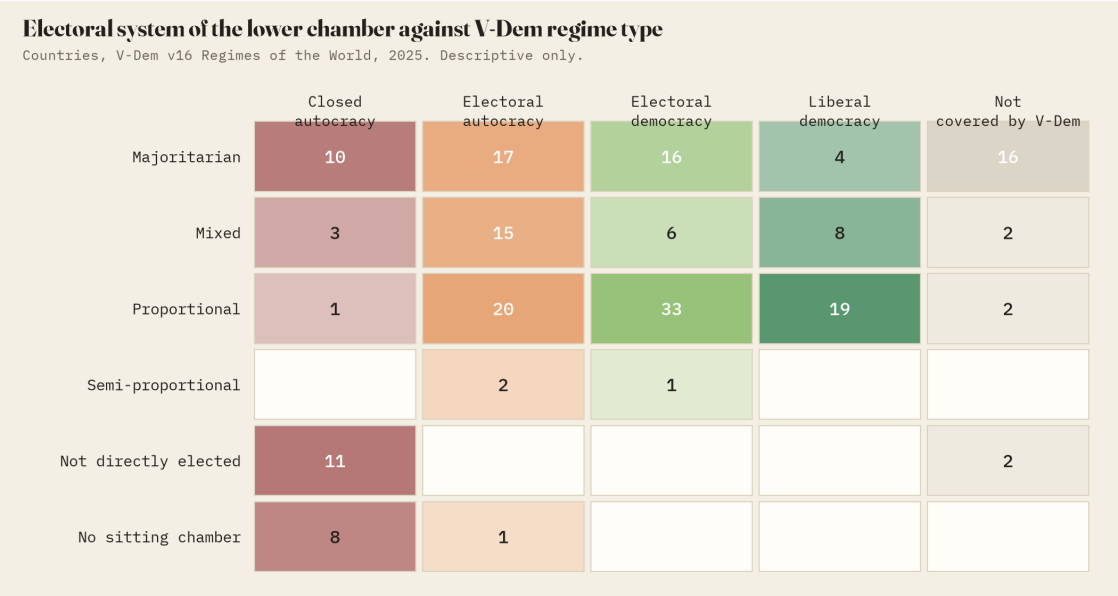


Figure 5: Electoral system of the lower or only chamber against V-Dem Regimes of the World (2025), countries.

president-parliamentary ones; among presidential republics the share is 55%, among parliamentary republics 69%. These contrasts echo long-standing arguments about presidentialism (Linz, 1990; Cheibub, 2007) and semi-presidential subtypes (Elgie, 2011), but they are bivariate and descriptive: region, colonial inheritance, wealth and history shape both institutions and democracy, and in authoritarian states constitutions often describe the form rather than the reality of power.

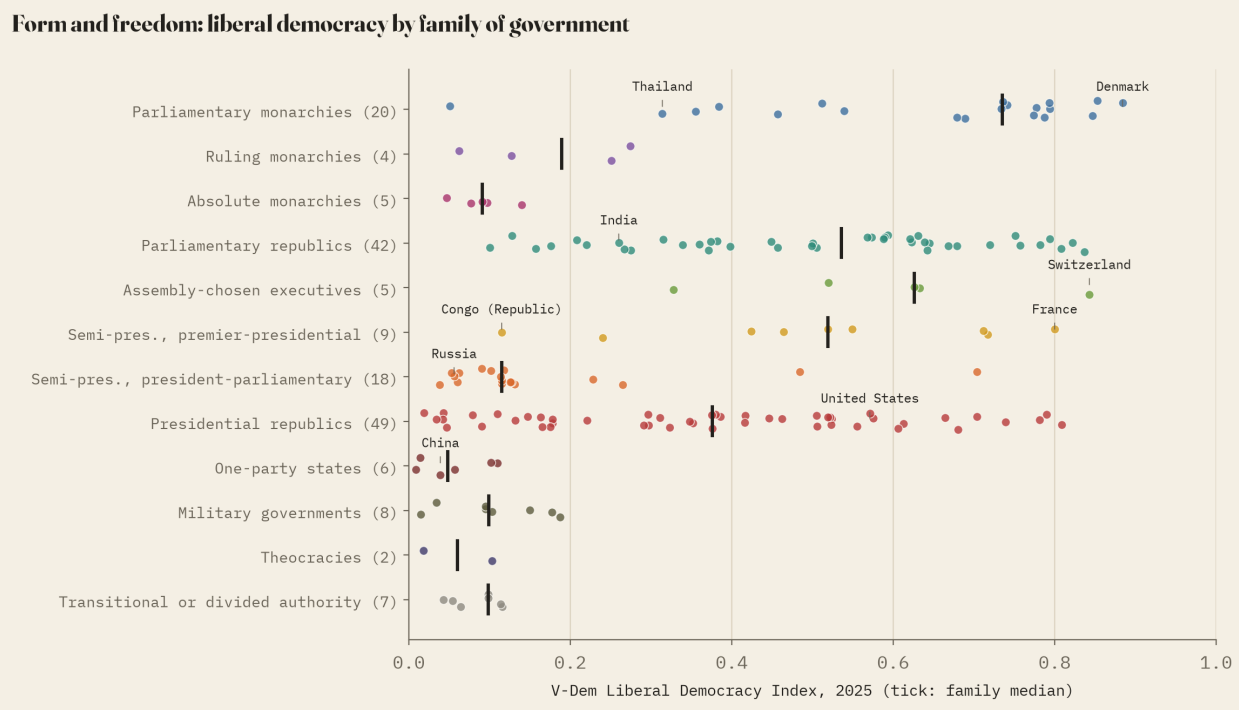


Figure 6: V-Dem Liberal Democracy Index by family (2025); ticks mark medians.

Table 3: Agreement between V-Dem and the Factbook, countries per field. Other: not applicable (no elected chamber), derived from another field, or coded by hand only.

Field	Agree	Disagree	One source	Hand decision	Other
Head of state	166	5	17	9	
Office filled by				14	183
Executive	144	30		23	
HoS and HoG	164	10	23		
Territory			181	16	
Chambers	164	4	25	4	
Electoral system	149	2	16	13	17
Power sharing				4	193

4.5 Agreement between sources and hand decisions

Where both sources speak to a field they agree in most cases (Table 3). 51 country and field cells in 48 countries still disagree after the rules are applied. The largest group (14) are states the Factbook labels presidential that also have a prime minister whom V-Dem codes the president as able to dismiss; others are monarchies the Factbook calls parliamentary where V-Dem codes a ruling monarch (Jordan, Morocco) and military regimes the Factbook lists under their constitutional label. 83 hand decisions in 60 countries (66 rated high confidence, 17 medium) settle the remaining hard cases, among them the United Kingdom's asymmetric devolution, France's constitutional premier-presidentialism, Switzerland's directorial executive, Iran's Supreme Leader, Bosnia's federal structure and ethnic presidency, Lebanon's confessional power sharing, the Holy See, Andorra's co-princes, Malaysia's elective monarchy, the United Arab Emirates as a federation of absolute monarchies, and the transitional or military governments of Libya, Myanmar, Afghanistan, Sudan and Haiti (Table 4). Every decision, with its reason and citation, is in the released data.

Table 4: Classification of the hardest cases, with the hand decisions that set them (identifiers as in data/hand_decisions.csv; "rule" where the sources agree and no decision was needed).

Country	Classification	Decisions
United Kingdom	Ceremonial monarchy; Parliamentary; Regionalised; FPTP	H01
France	Republic; Semi-pres. (premier-pres.); Unitary; Two-round	H11
Switzerland	Republic; Directorial; Federal; List PR	H13 H14
Iran	Republic; Theocratic; Unitary; Two-round	H16 H17
China	Republic; One-party state; Unitary, auton. regions; Indirect/appointed	nan
Russia	Republic; Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.); Federal; Parallel	nan
Bosnia and Herzegovina	Republic; Parliamentary; Federal; List PR; ethnic power sharing	H05 H06 H07
Lebanon	Republic; Parliamentary; Unitary; List PR; confessional power sharing	H08
Holy See (Vatican City)	Absolute monarchy; Theocratic; Unitary; Indirect/appointed	H21 H22 H23
Andorra	Ceremonial monarchy; Parliamentary; Unitary; Parallel	H24 H25 H26
Malaysia	Ceremonial monarchy; Parliamentary; Federal; FPTP	H27
United Arab Emirates	Absolute monarchy; Royal (absolute); Federal; Indirect/appointed	H29 H30 H31
Libya	Republic; Transitional; Unitary; Parallel	H32 H33
Myanmar	Republic; Military government; Unitary; None sitting	H34
Afghanistan	Theocratic emirate; Theocratic; Unitary; None sitting	H18 H19 H20
Sudan	Republic; Military government; Unitary; None sitting	H35 H36
Haiti	Republic; Transitional; Unitary; None sitting	H37 H38

5 Discussion

Moving from a binary to eight fields changes what a world map of government shows. At family level the map is dominated by two large blocks, presidential republics in the Americas and Africa and parliamentary systems in Europe, South Asia and the old Commonwealth, with a belt of president-parliamentary systems across North Africa and the former Soviet Union and a small but populous set of one-party states in East Asia. At the level of exact systems, institutional design turns out to be highly individual: two in five countries have a combination nobody else uses, among them China, Indonesia and Russia. Shared systems cluster regionally, which is what one would expect from diffusion of constitutional models, from post-communist Europe's list-PR parliamentary republics to Latin America's presidential list-PR republics and the Caribbean realms' Westminster template.

The classification separates form from quality on purpose. That France and the Republic of the Congo share an exact constitutional form, or that ceremonial monarchy co-exists with both the highest and some of the lowest liberal democracy scores, are reminders that institutional labels are not regime outcomes. The descriptive associations reported here, between proportional representation, premier-presidential semi-presidentialism and parliamentary monarchy on one side and democracy on the other, are consistent with comparative research but should not be read causally.

6 Limitations

First, every typology flattens: degrees of federalism, of presidential power and of proportionality are continuous, and the thresholds used (for example V-Dem's in-practice indicator at 0.5 for the semi-presidential subtype) decide borderline cases. Second, the two sources differ in kind: V-Dem

codes practice through expert surveys, with uncertainty; the Factbook describes the constitution and sometimes lags behind changes. Third, the electoral system is that of the latest coded election and may since have been reformed. Fourth, V-Dem does not cover 22 small states, whose fields rest on the Factbook and hand decisions. Fifth, the reference date is the start of 2026, and some countries (Guinea, Myanmar, Syria) were changing as it passed. Sixth, power sharing is coded narrowly and reserved seats for minorities are not coded. Finally, Wikidata and Wikipedia, natural third sources, could not be used in this version.

7 Conclusion

The world's 197 states fall into 12 families of government but 112 exact systems, and 80 countries, holding 42% of humanity, share their system with nobody. Classifying form and quality separately, from cross-checked open sources with every judgement documented, gives a map of how countries are put together that sits beside, rather than replaces, maps of how democratic they are.

Data and code availability

The interactive map is at https://maps.tristanhotham.com/government-types/. Data and code are at https://github.com/Tristan-Hotham/government-types and archived with this paper at https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23863540. Because the data include V-Dem values, the derived data, text and figures are released under CC BY-SA 4.0; code under the MIT licence. The Factbook is public domain, World Bank data CC BY 4.0 and Natural Earth public domain.

AI statement

I wrote the text, with drafting and editing assistance from Claude (Anthropic), which also helped prepare the analysis code. I reviewed and checked all text and results.

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A All 197 countries

Table 5: Classification of every country. Family codes: PM Parliamentary monarchies; RM Ruling monarchies; AM Absolute monarchies; PR Parliamentary republics; AE Assembly-chosen executives; SP Semi-presidential, premier-presidential; SR Semi-presidential, president-parliamentary; PS Presidential republics; OP One-party states; MI Military governments; TH Theocracies; TR Transitional or divided authority.

Country	Fam.	Executive	Territory	Chambers	Electoral system	V-Dem regime
Afghanistan	TH	Theocratic	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Albania	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Algeria	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Andorra	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	not in V-Dem
Angola	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Antigua and Barbuda	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Argentina	PS	Presidential	Federal	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Armenia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Australia	PM	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	Alternative vote	Liberal democracy
Austria	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Azerbaijan	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Bahamas	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Bahrain	RM	Dualist	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Closed autocracy
Bangladesh	TR	Transitional	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Barbados	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Liberal democracy
Belarus	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Closed autocracy
Belgium	PM	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Belize	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Benin	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Bhutan	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Electoral democracy
Bolivia	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	MMP	Electoral democracy
Bosnia and Herzegovina	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Botswana	AE	Parl., exec. president	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Brazil	PS	Presidential	Federal	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Brunei	AM	Royal (absolute)	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	not in V-Dem
Bulgaria	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Burkina Faso	MI	Military government	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Burundi	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Cabo Verde	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Cambodia	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Cameroon	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Canada	PM	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Central African Republic	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Chad	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Chile	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
China	OP	One-party state	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Colombia	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Comoros	PS	Presidential	Federal	Unicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Congo (Republic)	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Costa Rica	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Croatia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Cuba	OP	One-party state	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	Closed autocracy
Cyprus	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Czechia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Côte d'Ivoire	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
DR Congo	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Denmark	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Djibouti	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Unicameral	MMP	Electoral autocracy
Dominica	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Dominican Republic	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Ecuador	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Egypt	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
El Salvador	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Equatorial Guinea	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Eritrea	OP	One-party state	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Estonia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Eswatini	AM	Royal (absolute)	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Closed autocracy
Ethiopia	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Fiji	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Finland	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
France	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Liberal democracy
Gabon	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Gambia	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Georgia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Germany	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	MMP	Liberal democracy
Ghana	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Greece	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Grenada	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Guatemala	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Guinea	MI	Military government	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Guinea-Bissau	MI	Military government	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Guyana	AE	Parl., exec. president	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Haiti	TR	Transitional	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Holy See (Vatican City)	TH	Theocratic	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	not in V-Dem
Honduras	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Hungary	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	MMP	Electoral autocracy
Iceland	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
India	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Indonesia	PS	Presidential	Unitary, auton. regions	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Iran	TH	Theocratic	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Iraq	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Unicameral	SNTV	Electoral autocracy
Ireland	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	STV	Liberal democracy
Israel	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Italy	PR	Parliamentary	Regionalised	Bicameral	Parallel	Liberal democracy
Jamaica	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Japan	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	Parallel	Liberal democracy
Jordan	RM	Dualist	Unitary	Bicameral	Parallel	Closed autocracy

Country	Fam.	Executive	Territory	Chambers	Electoral system	V-Dem regime
Kazakhstan	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Kenya	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Kiribati	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	not in V-Dem
Kosovo	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Kuwait	RM	Dualist	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Kyrgyzstan	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	SNTV	Electoral autocracy
Laos	OP	One-party state	Unitary	Unicameral	Block vote	Closed autocracy
Latvia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Lebanon	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Lesotho	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	MMP	Electoral democracy
Liberia	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Libya	TR	Transitional	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Closed autocracy
Liechtenstein	RM	Dualist	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	not in V-Dem
Lithuania	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Liberal democracy
Luxembourg	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Madagascar	MI	Military government	Unitary	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Malawi	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Malaysia	PM	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Maldives	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Mali	MI	Military government	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Malta	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	STV	Electoral democracy
Marshall Islands	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	Block vote	not in V-Dem
Mauritania	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Mauritius	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	Block vote	Electoral democracy
Mexico	PS	Presidential	Federal	Bicameral	MMP	Electoral autocracy
Micronesia	AE	Parl., exec. president	Federal	Unicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Moldova	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Monaco	RM	Dualist	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	not in V-Dem
Mongolia	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Electoral democracy
Montenegro	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Morocco	RM	Dualist	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Closed autocracy
Mozambique	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Myanmar	MI	Military government	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Namibia	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Nauru	AE	Parl., exec. president	Unitary	Unicameral	Borda count	not in V-Dem
Nepal	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral democracy
Netherlands	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
New Zealand	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	MMP	Liberal democracy
Nicaragua	PS	Presidential	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Niger	MI	Military government	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Nigeria	PS	Presidential	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
North Korea	OP	One-party state	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	Closed autocracy
North Macedonia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Norway	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Oman	AM	Royal (absolute)	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Closed autocracy
Pakistan	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Palau	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Palestine	TR	Transitional	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Electoral autocracy
Panama	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Electoral democracy
Papua New Guinea	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	Alternative vote	Electoral autocracy
Paraguay	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Peru	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Philippines	PS	Presidential	Unitary, auton. regions	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Poland	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Portugal	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Qatar	AM	Royal (absolute)	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Romania	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Russia	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Federal	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Rwanda	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Saint Kitts and Nevis	PM	Parliamentary	Federal	Unicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Saint Lucia	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Saint Vincent and the Grenadines	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Samoa	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
San Marino	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	not in V-Dem
Saudi Arabia	AM	Royal (absolute)	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Senegal	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Electoral democracy
Serbia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Seychelles	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Liberal democracy
Sierra Leone	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Singapore	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	Party block vote	Electoral autocracy
Slovakia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Slovenia	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Solomon Islands	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
Somalia	PR	Parliamentary	Federal	Bicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
South Africa	AE	Parl., exec. president	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
South Korea	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	MMP	Liberal democracy
South Sudan	TR	Transitional	Unitary	Bicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
Spain	PM	Parliamentary	Regionalised	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Sri Lanka	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Sudan	MI	Military government	Unitary	None sitting	None sitting	Closed autocracy
Suriname	AE	Parl., exec. president	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Sweden	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Switzerland	AE	Directorial	Federal	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Syria	TR	Transitional	Unitary	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
São Tomé and Príncipe	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Taiwan	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Unicameral	Parallel	Liberal democracy
Tajikistan	PS	Presidential	Unitary, auton. regions	Bicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Tanzania	PS	Presidential	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Thailand	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	MMP	Electoral autocracy
Timor-Leste	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral democracy
Togo	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Tonga	RM	Dualist	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	not in V-Dem
Trinidad and Tobago	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary, auton. regions	Bicameral	FPTP	Liberal democracy
Tunisia	SR	Semi-pres. (pres.-parl.)	Unitary	Bicameral	Two-round	Electoral autocracy
Turkey	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	List PR	Electoral autocracy
Turkmenistan	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	Closed autocracy
Tuvalu	PM	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	Block vote	not in V-Dem
Uganda	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Ukraine	SP	Semi-pres. (premier-pres.)	Unitary, auton. regions	Unicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
United Arab Emirates	AM	Royal (absolute)	Federal	Unicameral	Indirect/appointed	Closed autocracy
United Kingdom	PM	Parliamentary	Regionalised	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy
United States	PS	Presidential	Federal	Bicameral	FPTP	Electoral democracy

Country	Fam.	Executive	Territory	Chambers	Electoral system	V-Dem regime
Uruguay	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	List PR	Liberal democracy
Uzbekistan	PS	Presidential	Unitary, auton. regions	Bicameral	Parallel	Closed autocracy
Vanuatu	PR	Parliamentary	Unitary	Unicameral	SNTV	Electoral democracy
Venezuela	PS	Presidential	Federal	Unicameral	Parallel	Electoral autocracy
Vietnam	OP	One-party state	Unitary	Unicameral	Two-round	Closed autocracy
Yemen	TR	Transitional	Unitary	Bicameral	FPTP	Closed autocracy
Zambia	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Unicameral	FPTP	Electoral autocracy
Zimbabwe	PS	Presidential	Unitary	Bicameral	MMP	Electoral autocracy